CIRCULAR NO.06/2025

No.S2/967/2024/M **Date 17.10.2025**

Subject: Guidelines to Enhance Port Efficiency and Productivity Monitoring Parameters

To ensure seamless vessel operations, reduced pre-berthing delay, and improved turnaround time at Chennai Port, the following comprehensive guidelines are issued for strict compliance by all Vessel Masters, Shipping Agents, and Port Users. These measures are aimed at achieving operational efficiency, transparency, and real-time productivity monitoring.

1. **Pre-Arrival Coordination**

Shipping Agents shall submit the Pilot Memo Application well in advance and confirm vessel arrival particulars with the Signal Station / VTMS for necessary coordination and berth allocation through Phone and or VHF.

Agents must ensure that all statutory documents and pre-arrival notifications (including ETA updates) are uploaded in the Port Community System (PCS) not less than 24 hours before arrival.

2. **Timely Readiness Reporting**

On completion of cargo operations and readiness to sail, the Vessel Master shall report readiness for pilotage at least one hour prior to the requested pilot time through VHF Ch 10.

Agents and Masters must give enough notice not less than one hour, in order to plan the inbound vessel for the vacating Berth.

3. **Communication Protocol**

Vessels must maintain a continuous radio watch on VHF Channel 10 and promptly respond to Port Signal Station / VTMS instructions.

Any change in vessel readiness status must be immediately communicated to avoid disruption in pilot deployment and incoming vessel scheduling.

4. **Pilot Boarding Arrangements**

Prior to pilot request, the Master shall ensure:

The pilot ladder is properly rigged on the sea-side at an appropriate height above water level. If freeboard exceeds 9 meters, a combination ladder (pilot + accommodation ladder) is to be rigged securely.

The pilot ladder shall be inspected and certified by a responsible ship's officer before the pilot boards.

5. **Operational Readiness**

Main engine, steering gear, mooring gear, and navigational equipment must be fully operational prior to pilot boarding.

Gangway and shore connections shall be secured for sea before departure.

Port and immigration clearances must be onboard before sailing.

6. **False Readiness and Compliance**

Any false signal or misrepresentation of readiness will be treated as an operational violation and attract penalties as per the Schedule of Rates (SOR).

Agents and Masters are reminded that accurate reporting is essential for optimizing vessel scheduling and ensuring fairness in port utilization.

Compliance with these directives will ensure smoother vessel movement, improved berth productivity, and enhanced turnaround efficiency — aligning Chennai Port with global best practices.

This Circular supersedes all previous instructions issued on the subject, including **Circular No. 02/2024 dated 02.07.2024.**

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Harbour Master

Chennai Port Authority

To,

All Shipping Agents and Masters of vessel calling Chennai Port.